Sociocultural Factors and Responsible Young Adulthood

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Abstract

This study explores the relationship between sociocultural factors and responsible young adulthood. Sociocultural factors, encompassing social norms, cultural values, family dynamics, and peer pressure, were evaluated alongside indicators of responsible young adulthood: sense of responsibility, accountability, commitment, and ethical practice. Using a descriptive-correlational research design, data were gathered from a randomly selected sample comprising 30% of students across all programs. Results indicated a "high" level of sociocultural factors (mean = 4.10) and a "very high" level of responsible young adulthood (mean = 4.26). Notably, family dynamics and cultural values had the strongest influence. Statistical analysis revealed a significant positive correlation between sociocultural factors and responsible young adulthood (Pearson $r = 0.701$, $p < 0.01$), underscoring the critical role of sociocultural contexts in fostering responsibility and ethical behavior among young adults. The findings emphasize the importance of integrating cultural and family-oriented initiatives in educational and policy frameworks to enhance the holistic development of young adults.

KEYWORDS: SOCIOCULTURAL FACTORS, CULTURAL VALUES, FAMILY DYNAMICS, PEER PRESSURE, RESPONSIBLE YOUNG ADULTHOOD, ACCOUNTABILITY, RESPONSIBILITY, SOCIAL NORMS

INTRODUCTION

Entering adulthood is thrilling, but it also brings new questions and important life skills. You'll have to take on new responsibilities in a constantly changing world.

In recent decades, the shift from adolescence to adulthood has changed significantly in many countries. Since the late 1960s, sociocultural changes in Western nations have shown that this transition is no longer a quick phase where people make major life decisions, like about work and family. Instead, it has become a longer period during which individuals can choose when and if to make those choices. Keniston (1968) argued that in post-industrial societies, "youth" emerged as a distinct stage of development where young people must figure out their social roles.

The transition to adulthood in America today is both exciting and complex, marked by new responsibilities and questions (Hamilton 2016). Unlike in the past, where marriage was a key sign of adulthood, modern young Americans prioritize personal responsibility, independent decision-making, and financial independence as the main indicators of becoming an adult. This shift reflects broader cultural changes that emphasize individualism over traditional milestones like marriage. Additionally, the legal age of adulthood varies, affecting how society defines maturity, often leading to a disconnect between legal status and actual life experiences.

In the U.S., the extension of parental financial support into young adulthood has raised concerns about how it affects young people's independence and responsibility. A study using data from the Transition to Adulthood Supplement of Johnson and Ridgeway (2024) found that young adults who receive financial help from their families tend to view themselves as less independent and feel less financially responsible. They also worry more about money. However, the study did not support the idea that this financial support undermines their independence; instead, it suggested that financial assistance can sometimes be helpful. Interestingly, earlier feelings of independence and financial concerns often predicted whether young adults would receive financial support later on, indicating a selection process rather than a direct impact of the support itself.

Peer pressure is the one factor that significantly impacts responsible adulthood, affecting decision-making and self-control. According to Fontenot (2024) peer pressure persists into

early adulthood, influencing behaviors such as substance use and financial decisions. Younger adults often struggle more with self-control in social situations compared to older adults, who generally manage peer influence better as they age. The need for social acceptance can lead young adults to engage in behaviors they might otherwise avoid, such as excessive drinking or unhealthy lifestyle choices. This pressure can shape their attitudes toward responsibility and independence.

According to Cruz et al., (2022) Peer pressure significantly impacts responsible adulthood in the Philippines, particularly among the youth. It can lead to both positive and negative behaviors, influencing decisions related to substance use, academic integrity, and social interactions. Research indicates that young adults often succumb to peer pressure to gain acceptance, which may result in risky behaviors such as drug use or reckless driving. Positive peer influences can promote healthy habits and community engagement, fostering personal growth and responsibility.

There was a study in the Philippines specifically in San Agustin Institute of Technology, and they examine how parental influence and peer pressure affect alcohol use among college students. It involved 269 students from San Agustin Institute of Technology, using a standardized questionnaire for data collection. The results showed that students perceived moderate parental influence and low peer pressure, which correlated with low alcohol consumption. However, both parental influence and peer pressure significantly predicted alcohol use. This indicates that students' drinking habits are shaped by their social interactions with parents and peers. Effective communication about alcohol-related issues from parents can help reduce excessive drinking among students (Calonia 2023).

In University of Cebu - Main Campus, a study conducted and explored on what are the purpose this young adult in participating in organization at the University of Cebu - Main Campus, Sumicad et al., (2023) identified reasons for joining groups, experiences within them, and their impact on self-concept. They found this reasons like socializing, altruism, self-development, benefits, and peer influence. It boosted also their self-confidence, self-worth, and direction in life. These insights aim to raise awareness about group involvement's effects on young adults' self-concept in being responsible. Perspectives on social norms involve understanding how these informal rules shape behavior within communities. Social norms are the unwritten expectations that guide what is considered acceptable or appropriate behavior.

A study investigated how Our personal perspectives affects the process of being a adult. Results showed that students had strong present hedonistic, past negative, and past positive perspectives, it helps a young adulthood to be responsible. The research suggests that understanding these perspectives can help students develop personally. However, it also warns about potential downsides: focusing too much on the future can cause negative impacts, present hedonism might lead to neglecting long-term goals, and excessive nostalgia could hinder growth. The study recommends balanced approaches to address these issues and suggests further research with larger samples and additional factors like life satisfaction. (Arapoc et al., 2024)

Dayap, Sarausa, Sisican, and Murcia (2024) State the importance of social responsibility in order be a responsible adulthood. Practicing this moral and ethical values are very essential in maintaining positive image inside the community.

A study in Davao City examines the relationship between social competence and civic engagement among senior high school students, highlighting how cultural values influence their involvement in community activities.

Cultural values play a crucial role in shaping behaviors and attitudes, guiding students' participation in civic activities. For instance, values such as respect, cooperation, and community solidarity encourage students to engage actively in local initiatives. This engagement not only fosters social skills but also enhances their understanding of societal issues, promoting responsible

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

SOCIOCULTURAL FACTORS

Societal Norms

Social norms, akin to unwritten guidelines, dictate appropriate behavior within groups or societies. These norms shape our perceptions of right and wrong and significantly influence our financial decisions, such as spending, saving, investing, and collaborating. We often adhere to these norms to gain acceptance or avoid judgment. For instance, in some cultures, norms discourage displaying wealth, resulting in more frugal spending, while

other cultures prioritize sharing and fairness, promoting business cooperation. Understanding the impact of social norms on financial decisions is crucial for comprehending why people make certain economic choices across different cultures. Social norms can be a powerful tool to encourage positive changes and reduce unfair treatment of certain groups, like young girls in developing countries. Social norms, which are influenced by culture, can have a real impact on how people make choices that benefit society. Hence, scientists are starting to understand how social norms work and how they can affect our economic behavior. (Fahrati, 2023).

Social norms play a crucial role in fostering collective action for environmental management. When communities come together to protect their surroundings, it's often driven by a shared understanding of what's considered "normal" or expected behavior. Participants in these efforts highlight the importance of community-driven initiatives, like cleanups and resource sharing, as well as collaborative decision-making processes. These social norms create a sense of responsibility and accountability among community members, leading to improved waste management practices and the conservation of natural resources. By recognizing and leveraging existing social norms, we can effectively mobilize communities to embrace sustainable environmental practices (Egunjobi et al., 2020; Igwe et al., 2021).

The study "Social Norms and Dietary Behaviors Among Young Adults" by Jennifer E. Pelletier and colleagues (2013), contributes to the existing literature on social norms and weight-related behaviors among young adults in two significant ways. Firstly, it utilizes data on descriptive social norms from three types of social contacts (family, friends, and significant others) and their proximity (whether young adults live with these social contacts) to compare the influence of different sources of social norms. Secondly, the study comprehensively examines dietary intake, considering both unhealthy behaviors (like consumption of sugar-sweetened beverages and fast food) and healthy behaviors (such as fruit and vegetable consumption and home meal preparation), to determine if the relationship between social norms and dietary behaviors is consistent across these behaviors. All examined behaviors are linked to overall diet quality and health outcomes, especially in adolescents and young adults. The hypothesis posits that social norms significantly impact young adults' dietary behaviors, with a stronger association for those living with their social contacts. Additionally, it is hypothesized that norms from friends and

significant others have a greater influence on dietary behaviors than family norms, based on prior findings related to alcohol use norms.

Cultural Values

Each culture has its own set of values. Some focus more on endurance or courage or resilience or optimism. According to Scales et al. (2015), cultural values profoundly impact on responsible young adulthood by shaping the core dimensions of development. In their study, eight essential dimensions were identified: social, psychological, behavioral, educational, occupational, health, ethical, and civic. These dimensions of cultural values guide young adults in their transition from adolescence to adulthood, emphasizing the importance of developmental relationships and opportunities. Indicators such as emotional well-being, ethical behavior, and civic engagement reflect how cultural contexts influence young adults' preparedness for this transition.

Understanding cultural values is essential for shaping responsible young adulthood, as these values influence various aspects of an individual's life. Culture is learned and socially shared, affecting social responsibilities, sexual expression, and the development of belief systems. For example, the degree of perceived autonomy among adolescents varies significantly across cultures, impacting how they navigate their emerging independence (Libretexts, 2020).

According to Yassin (2024), moving between countries presents both opportunities and challenges. Growing up abroad can foster open mindedness and flexibility in young people, but it can also cause stress and disrupt identity exploration which has two concepts: inner and outer identity. Inner identity is about personal characteristics, while outer identity involves cultural aspects. These influence each other. The process of identity development involves exploring and choosing aspects of identity, but living abroad can complicate this and sometimes lead to identity confusion. Some young people may develop a blended identity, incorporating elements from different cultures, depending on where they are and with whom they are spending time, adapting to their present surroundings. For example, they may understand both the culture of their country of birth and of the society they grew up as aspects of who they are. Hence, some adolescents and young adults are described to be developing a clear sense of identity abroad, but experience identity loss and confusion

when they return to their home country for university. At this point, they become aware of the differences between their identity and the identity of others. This can cause feelings of grief, loss, and separation from others.

Family Dynamics

Family relationships evolve during emerging adulthood and their impact on young adults' development. It emphasizes how family dynamics influence identity formation, autonomy, and responsibility as individuals transition to adulthood. Integrating these insights into your research on sociocultural factors could provide valuable context on family influences shaping responsible young adulthood, highlighting the effects of family relationships on accountability, commitment, and ethics. (Oliveira et al., 2020)

The study "How Does the Family Influence the Process of Transition to Adulthood: A Comparative Study of Young People with and without Family Ties in Spain" explores the impact of family dynamics on young adults' transition to responsible adulthood. It finds that family support and structure play a crucial role in shaping young adults' behaviors and attitudes: personal autonomy, stability, and social integration during the transition to adulthood. Young adults with strong family ties tend to exhibit more responsible behaviors, such as accountability and social maturity. Conversely, those without family support often face greater challenges in achieving these milestones. The study highlights the importance of family cohesion and adaptability in fostering a successful transition to adulthood. (Cano-López et al., 2021)

Parental support and family structure influence young adults' life satisfaction and psychological well-being. Examined factors like family cohabitation, perceived social support, and psychological distress, the study finds that young adults in two-parent households report higher life satisfaction and lower distress. These insights underscore family structure’s role as a protective or risk factor in young adults' well-being. This study’s nuanced approach offers useful context for understanding family dynamics in relation to responsible young adulthood. (Almeida et al., 2024).

Peer Pressure

Older teens and young adults may be peer pressured to engage in harmful activities like drinking alcohol, smoking, or reckless driving. At this age, peer pressure has the potential to affect a child's long-term health and well-being and put them into dangerous situations. Hence, adults are not exempt from facing societal expectations and peer judgment or influence. For example, they may carry the pressure of academic achievement in their career. They may also face challenges like wanting to “keep up with the Jones’” and feel pressure to purchase items they cannot afford to maintain an image that fits into their work, social, or neighborhood environment. (Puggle, 2022).

Peer pressure often manifests in subtle ways, prompting individuals to conform in behavior, appearance, and attitudes to gain social acceptance. This influence can lead to actions ranging from harmless conformity to potentially serious consequences. People, especially those lacking confidence or new to a social group, may look to others for cues on acceptable behavior, making it easy to think that if everyone else is doing something, it must be okay. While responding to peer pressure is a natural part of human behavior, there are some who are able to resist and stand their ground and those who are susceptible to peer pressure are particularly those who tend to seek validation from their peers (Lyness, 2015).

Based on the paper providing an extensive review of peer pressure "Peer Pressure: A Comprehensive Literature Review of the Last Two Decades" by Anita Sharma and Dr. K. Charulatha, published in the International Journal For Multidisciplinary Research (IJFMR) (2024), peer pressure has long been recognized as a significant influence on individuals' behaviors, attitudes, and decision-making processes, particularly during young adulthood. Peer pressure encompasses a range of social processes through which individuals are influenced by their peers to conform to certain norms, attitudes, or behaviors. It can manifest in various forms, including overt coercion, subtle persuasion, modeling of behavior, and conformity to group expectations. Studies have identified distinct types of peer pressure, such as peer pressure to engage in risky behaviors (e.g., substance abuse, delinquency), conformity to social norms (e.g., fashion trends, academic achievement), and pressure to conform to group ideologies or beliefs. The findings underscore the multifaceted nature of peer influence on moral development, encompassing both positive and negative effects. Peer pressure continues to exert a profound influence on individuals' lives, with implications for social behavior, psychological well-being, and developmental outcomes Hence, the study concludes the importance of recognizing the role of peers in shaping moral values and decision-making processes for designing effective interventions and promoting ethical behavior across various contexts.

RESPONSIBLE YOUNG ADULTHOOD

Sense of Responsibility

The meaning of responsibility, especially in young adults, plays an important role in contemporary life. It has an impact on the family life, social relations, ways of a work

performance and many other aspects. Responsibility is presented in close connection with action. It is not a matter of choice it is an obligation. Therefore, responsibility is an attribute of adulthood. Human beings confronted by real problems have to make independent decisions. As imperfect individuals, they have the right to make mistakes. However, it is important to consciously perceive, assess and predict their effects. Damage caused by making the wrong choice must be repaired. The ability to change as a consequence of initiated actions is an inherent property of the human being (Duda, 2018).

Sense of Accountability

People often view young people, especially those who study at tertiary education levels, as the nation's future leader. Attached with this vision are leaders with exceptional leadership skills and integrity in themselves, which is acquired by participating in various programs and activities held by university. This paper suggests the factors that contribute to accountability among undergraduate students in Malaysian higher education institutions, as accountability is regarded as part of a leader's integrity. Data collected from a set of questionnaires prepared were analyzed by using Statistical Package for Social Sciences (IBM SPSS) 23.0 and exploratory factor analysis (EFA) were employed to test the validity of questionnaires that has been answered by 744 participants. There were abundant studies and discussions from previous research regarding accountability that focused on government and corporate workers, school’s accountability, and others while little research are found related to student’s accountability. Results show that identity, environment, moral values, pressure, and students’ perception of corruption were the contributing factors of accountability among undergraduate students while religion and culture were insignificant factor in this study. Thus, this study is compelling as it is solely focused on undergraduate students that are part of the public community and academic community (Din, et al., 2024).

Ability to Respond to Commitments

In "Adolescent Development and Juvenile Justice," Steinberg (2016) explores the interplay between adolescent development and the juvenile justice system. The author discusses key developmental changes that occur during adolescence, including cognitive, emotional, and social maturation. Steinberg emphasizes that adolescents are often still developing the capacity for responsible decision-making, which affects their

ability to respond to commitments, including legal responsibilities. He highlights the influence of peer relationships, risk-taking behavior, and the evolving sense of identity during this critical developmental period.

In the study by Perry and Smart (2016), titled "The Role of College Commitment in Predicting Academic Success in Young Adults," the authors investigate how college commitment influences academic outcomes among young adults. The research emphasizes the significance of college commitment—defined as the psychological attachment and dedication students have towards their institution and academic goals. The authors explore the relationship between this commitment and various indicators of academic success, such as GPA, persistence, and overall satisfaction with the college experience. Overall, Perry and Smart highlight the critical role of college commitment in fostering academic achievement and suggest that educational institutions should focus on strategies to enhance student commitment for better outcomes.

In the study by Guan and Cheah (2016), titled "Cultural Influences on the Development of Commitment in Young Adults," the authors explore how cultural contexts shape the formation and expression of commitment among young adults. The research examines the interplay between cultural values, social norms, and the development of commitment in various domains, including family, relationships, and career. The authors argue that cultural backgrounds significantly influence how young adults perceive and navigate their commitments. Overall, Guan and Cheah emphasize the importance of understanding cultural influences on commitment development to support young adults in navigating their responsibilities and relationships effectively.

Actively Practice Ethics and Morals

Morality is a system of beliefs about what is right and good compared to what is wrong or bad. Moral development refers to changes in moral beliefs as a person grows older and gains maturity. Moral beliefs are related to, but not identical with, moral behavior: it is possible to know the right thing to do, but not actually do it (Seifert & Sutton, 2020).

Both morality and ethics loosely have to do with distinguishing the difference between “good and bad” or “right and wrong.” Many people think of morality as something that’s personal and normative, whereas ethics is the standards of “good and bad” distinguished

by a certain community or social setting (Grannan, 2023).

Ethics represents the moral code that guides a person's choices and behaviors throughout their life. The idea of a moral code extends beyond the individual to include what is determined to be right, and wrong, for a community or society at large. Ethics is concerned with rights, responsibilities, use of language, what it means to live an ethical life, and how people make moral decisions. We may think of moralizing as an intellectual exercise, but more frequently it's an attempt to make sense of our gut instincts and reactions. It's a subjective concept, and many people have strong and stubborn beliefs about what's right and wrong that can place them in direct contrast to the moral beliefs of others. Yet even though morals may vary from person to person, religion to religion, and culture to culture, many have been found to be universal, stemming from basic human emotions (Psychology Today,2024)

METHODOLOGY

This section of the research explains the steps taken in acquiring the needed data to answer the following research questions used for tabulation and analysis. This includes the research design, population of the respondents, locale, instrument, sampling method, and data gathering procedure.

Data Gathering Procedure

To gather the data, the researchers will first have their survey questionnaire validated by authorized and qualified individuals. They will then ask permission from the Office of the School President to conduct pilot testing. Once permission is granted, they will pilot-test the 5-point Likert scale questionnaire with students from different year levels. The participants will have a set timeframe to complete and submit the questionnaires. The researchers will ensure that the privacy of all respondents is protected.

Feedback from the pilot test will help refine the questionnaire for clarity and effectiveness. After finalizing the questionnaire, it will be distributed to the students. Once all responses are collected, the data will be analyzed using statistical tools to find patterns and connections between different factors (personality, motivation, stereotyping, social distance, and attitude) and English language learning outcomes.

The data collection methods are designed to give a complete understanding of the sociocultural factors that affect ESL learning among respondents. Using quantitative approaches, the study aims to provide a thorough analysis that can help develop effective strategies to improve ESL education at the institution.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Presented in this chapter are the analysis and interpretation of data sequenced to the order by which they are presented as problem statement.

Table 1 The Level of Sociocultural Factors in terms of Social Norms

No.	Item	Mean	Description
1	I behave in accordance to the dictates of my family and cultural groups.	4.05	High
2	My choices are based on the social norms of my family and cultural groups.	3.58	High
3	I developed a sense of responsibility and accountability to my family and cultural groups.	4.23	Very High
4	The decisions I make can affect my family and cultural groups.	3.82	High
5	I am aware that the decisions I make can affect others also.	4.15	High
Overall		3.97	High

Sociocultural Factors

This part of the study presents sociocultural factors, which comprise indicators such as social norms, cultural values, family dynamics, and peer pressure.

Social Norms. Table 1 shows the data level of sociocultural factors among the young adult students of Davao Vision Colleges, Inc. in terms of their social norms. This indicator is rated as high. The mean scores are as follows: 4.05 for I behave in accordance to the dictates of my family and cultural groups; 3.58 for My choices are based on the social norms of my family and cultural groups; 4.23 for I developed a sense of responsibility and accountability to my family and cultural groups; 3.82 for The decisions I make can affect my family and cultural groups; and 4.15 for I am aware that the decisions I make can affect others also.

The overall mean score is 3.97. It means that the level of sociocultural factors among learners. in terms of social norms, is often observed.

Social norms, akin to unwritten guidelines, dictate appropriate behavior within groups or societies. These norms shape our perceptions of right and wrong and significantly influence our financial decisions, such as spending, saving, investing, and collaborating (Fahrati, 2023).

The analysis of the table reveals that sociocultural factors, particularly social norms, have a strong influence on individual behavior and decision-making. The high mean scores across all items indicate that individuals heavily rely on the expectations and norms set their family and cultural groups. Specifically, high levels of adherence to social norms in behavior and decision-making, as well as a strong sense of responsibility and accountability, were evident. These findings suggest that social norms are deeply ingrained and play a crucial role in shaping individual actions within these communities.

The implications of these findings are significant for educational and policy interventions, understanding the strong influence of sociocultural norms can help educators and policy makers design culturally sensitive programs that align with these norms, ensuring greater acceptance and effectiveness. Additionally, fostering awareness of the impact of decisions on the broader community can enhance social responsibility and cohesion. Overall, acknowledging the pervasive role of sociocultural factors in shaping behavior can lead to more tailored and impactful strategies in various social and education settings.

Table 2. The Level of Sociocultural Factors in terms of Cultural Values

No.	Item	Mean	Description
1	Cultural values plays a very important role in my life.	4.45	Very High
2	Cultural values teaches me what is right and wrong.	4.40	Very High
3	Cultural values are a guide in my growth and development as a person.	4.28	Very High
4	Cultural values help shape my emotional well-being.	4.11	High
5	My ethical behavior and civic engagement are influenced by my cultural values.	4.97	Very High
Overall		4.24	Very High

Cultural Values. Presented in Table 2 is the data level of sociocultural factors among the young adult students in terms of their cultural values. This indicator is rated as very high**.** The mean scores are as follows: 4.45 for *Cultural values plays a very important role in my life*; 4.40 for *Cultural values teaches me what is right and wrong*; 4.28 for *Cultural values are a guide in my growth and development as a person*; 4.11 for *Cultural values help shape my emotional well-being*; and 4.97 for My ethical behavior and civic engagement are influenced by my cultural values. The overall mean score is 4.24. It means that the level of sociocultural factors among the learners in terms of cultural values is always observed.

According to Scales et al (2015), cultural values profoundly impact on responsible young adulthood by shaping the core dimensions of development. In their study, eight essential dimensions were identified: social, psychological, behavioral, educational, occupational, health, ethical, and civic. These dimensions of cultural values guide young adults in their transition from adolescence to adulthood, emphasizing the importance of developmental relationships and opportunities. Indicators such as emotional well-being, ethical behavior, and civic engagement reflect how cultural context influences young adults' preparedness for this transition.

It indicates that cultural values play a significant role in individuals' lives. All items show high or very high mean scores, demonstrating the profound impact of cultural values on various aspects of personal development and behavior. For instance, the very high score (4.45) for the importance of cultural values in life highlights their central role. Similarly, cultural values as a guide for what is right and wrong (4.40) and their influence on ethical behavior and civic engagement (4.97) underscore their foundational influence on moral and social development.

These findings suggest that cultural values are deeply ingrained in individuals and significantly shape their worldview and actions. This emphasizes the need for educational and community programs to incorporate cultural values to be effective. Policies and interventions should consider these values to resonate with the target population and achieve desired outcomes. Understanding and integrating cultural values into various social and educational initiatives can enhance their acceptance and impact, fostering a more cohesive and value-driven society.

Table 3 The Level of Sociocultural Factors in terms of Cultural Values

No.	Item	Mean	Description
1	Cultural values plays a very important role in my life.	4.45	Very High
2	Cultural values teaches me what is right and wrong.	4.40	Very High
3	Cultural values are a guide in my growth and development as a person.	4.28	Very High
4	Cultural values help shape my emotional well-being.	4.11	High
5	My ethical behavior and civic engagement are influenced by my cultural values.	4.97	Very High
Overall		4.24	Very High

Family Dynamics. Revealed in Table 3 is the data level of sociocultural factors among the young adult students in terms of their family dynamics. This indicator is rated as very high**.** The mean scores are as follows: 4.16 for *My family circle influences my identity formation and autonomy*; 4.43 for *My family is a great influence in what I have become today*; 4.42 for *My family helps me develop my wholesome personality*; 4.23 for *Parental support influences my satisfying psychological well-being*; and 4.42 for *My family encourages me to face greater challenges*. The overall mean score is 4.35. It means that the level of sociocultural factors among learners of Davao Vision Colleges, Inc. in terms of family dynamics is always observed.

Family support and structure play a crucial role in shaping young adults' behaviors and attitudes: personal autonomy, stability, and social integration during the transition to adulthood (Cano-López et al., 2021).

It highlights the significant influence of family on personal development and well- being. The high and very high mean scores across all items indicate that family dynamics play a crucial role in shaping identity autonomy, personality, and psychological well-being. For example, the highest mean scores (4.42) for items related to the development of a

wholesome personality and encouragement to face challenges underscore the strong positive impact of family support.

These findings suggest that family dynamics are a foundational element in individual growth. Educational programs and policies should consider integrating family involvement to foster positive development. The very high overall mean score of 4.35 emphasizes the need for supportive family environments to enhance personal and psychological well-being. Future research could explore specific family practices that contribute most effectively to these positive outcomes, providing a blueprint for interventions aimed at strengthening family support systems.

Table 4 The Level of Sociocultural Factors in terms of Family Dynamics

No.	Item	Mean	Description
1	My family circle influences my identity formation and autonomy.	4.16	High
2	My family is a great influence in what I have become today.	4.43	Very High
3	My family helps me develop my wholesome personality.	4.42	Very High
4	Parental support influences my satisfying psychological well-being.	4.23	Very High
5	My family encourages me to face greater challenges.	4.42	Very High
Overall		4.35	Very High

Peer Pressure. Presented in Table 4 is the data level of sociocultural factors among the young adult students in terms of their peer pressure. This indicator is rated as high**.** The mean scores are as follows: 3.35 for *Friends influences my judgment*; 3.76 for *I face pressure in my career choice*; 3.92 for *I maintain my self-image despite peer pressure*; 4.17 for *My peers accept me for who I am*; and 4.16 for *My peers accept me for my ideologies and beliefs*. The overall mean score is 3.87. It means that the level of sociocultural factors in terms of peer pressure, is often observed.

This conforms to the findings of Lyness (2015), who highlighted that peer pressure often influences individuals' behavior, appearance, and attitudes as they seek social acceptance or validation. This study reinforces her perspective that peer pressure is a multifaceted sociocultural factor, influencing individuals in both supportive and challenging ways. Respondents exhibit a strong sense of peer validation and acceptance, while many maintain their individuality despite external pressures.

It provides valuable insights into how peer pressure affects various sociocultural factors. The mean scores reveal moderate to high levels of influence from peer pressure across different dimensions. For instance, the item "Friends influence my judgment" has a moderate mean score of 3.35, indicating that peer influence is significant but not overwhelming. On the other hand, items such as "I maintain my self-image despite peer pressure" and "My peers accept me for who I am" have high mean scores of 3.92 and 4.17, respectively. This suggests that while individuals feel the impact of peer pressure, they also possess a strong sense of self-identity and are generally accepted by their peers.

These findings imply that peer pressure plays a notable role in shaping individual behaviors and perceptions, but it does not completely override personal values and self- image. This balance between peer influence and personal autonomy is crucial for maintaining psychological well-being and social harmony. Educational programs and interventions aimed at adolescents and young adults should focus on fostering resilience and self-confidence to help individuals navigate peer pressure effectively. Additionally, promoting a supportive peer environment that values acceptance and respect can mitigate negative effects of peer pressure and enhance overall well-being. By understanding the dynamics of peer pressure, educators and policymakers can develop strategies that support healthy social interactions and personal development.

Table 5 The Level of Sociocultural Factors in terms of Peer Pressure

No.	Item	Mean	Description
1	Friends influences my judgment.	3.35	Moderate
2	I face pressure in my career choice.	3.76	High
3	I maintain my self-image despite peer pressure.	3.92	High
4	My peers accept me for who I am.	4.17	High

5	My peers accept me for my ideologies and beliefs.	4.16	High
Overall		3.87	High

Shown in Table 5 is the summary of the sociocultural factors among the young adult students Inc. 3.97 for *Social Norms*; 4.24 for *Cultural Values*; 4.35 for *Family Dynamics*; and 3.87 for *Peer Pressure*. The overall mean score is 4.10 described as high. It means that the level of sociocultural factors among young adult students of Davao Vision Colleges, Inc. is often manifested.

It showcases the influence of various sociocultural elements, with mean scores reflecting their impact levels. The indicators include Social Norms (mean: 3.97), Cultural Values (mean: 4.24), Family Dynamics (mean: 4.35), and Peer Pressure (mean: 3.87). Family Dynamics scored the highest, indicating a very high influence, followed by Cultural Values, both of which are crucial in shaping individual behavior and attitudes. Social Norms and Peer Pressure also show high influence, though slightly less intense.

These findings underscore the significant role of family and cultural values in individual development and social behavior. Educational and community programs should integrate family dynamics and cultural values to foster a supportive environment for personal growth. The high influence of social norms and peer pressure suggests the need for strategies that address peer influence while promoting positive social.

Table 6 Summary of Responsible Young Adulthood

Indicators	Mean	Level
Sense of Responsibility	4.27	Very High
Sense of Accountability	4.37	Very High
Ability to Respond to Commitments	4.06	High
Active Practice Ethics and Morals	4.34	Very High
Overall	4.26	Very High

Shown in Table 6 is the summary of the Responsible Young Adulthood among the young adult students 4.27 for *Sense of Responsibility*;

4.37 for *Sense of Accountability*; 4.06 for *Ability to Respond to Commitments*; and 4.34 for *Active Practice Ethics and Morals*. The overall mean score is 4.26 described as very high. It means that the level of responsible young adulthood among young adults of Davao Vision Colleges, Inc. students is always manifested.

The data summarizes the different aspects of responsible young adulthood, showcasing high levels across various indicators. The overall mean score of 4.26, described as "Very High," signifies that young adults exhibit commendable responsibility in multiple dimensions. Specifically, the "Sense of Accountability" has the highest mean score of 4.37, followed by "Active Practice Ethics and Morals" with a mean score of 4.34, both rated as "Very High." The "Sense of Responsibility" also holds a strong mean score of 4.27, while the "Ability to Respond to Commitments" has a slightly lower but still significant mean score of 4.06, categorized as "High." These findings can be leveraged.

Table 7 Level of Sociocultural Factors and Responsible Young Adulthood

Variables	Mean	Level
Sociocultural Factors	4.10	High
Responsible Young Adulthood	4.26	Very High

Presented in Table 7 is the level of Sociocultural Factors and Responsible Young Adulthood among the young adult students of Sociocultural factors has a total mean score of 4.10 which results in a high level and responsible young adulthood has a total mean score of 4.26 which is equivalent to very high level.

The data presents significant insights into the impact of sociocultural factors on responsible behavior among young adults. The table reveals that sociocultural factors have a "High" influence, with a mean score of 4.10. Meanwhile, responsible young adulthood is rated "Very High," with a mean score of 4.26, leading to an overall mean score of 4.18, also described as "High." These findings suggest that sociocultural factors play a substantial role in shaping the responsibility levels of young adults. The high scores indicate that these factors, such as cultural background, societal expectations, and social networks, significantly contribute to the development of responsible behavior. This data

can be used in a thesis to argue that enhancing sociocultural support systems can further promote responsible behavior in young adults. By acknowledging the strong influence of sociocultural factors, policymakers and educators can design targeted interventions that leverage these factors to support the holistic development of young adults.

FINDINGS, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter presents the summary, of the research work undertaken, the conclusions drawn and the recommendations made as an outgrowth of this study.

Findings

This study aims to determine the levels of sociocultural factors and responsible young adulthood among young adult students as well as their significant relationship. The proposed research is a pathway that could provide insight into what factors play the most critical roles, helping to understand how responsible behavior is nurtured. Chapter 1 discusses the statement of the problem. This research paper aims to determine the level of sociocultural factors in terms of social norms, cultural values, family dynamics, and peer pressure. It also seeks to know the level of responsible young adulthood in terms of a sense of responsibility, sense of accountability, ability to respond to commitments, and active practice ethics and morals. The study wants to know if there is a significant relationship between sociocultural factors and responsible young adulthood.

The salient findings of the study are as follows:

1. What is the level of sociocultural factors in terms of:

1.1 Social Norms

The level of sociocultural factors in terms of Social Norms is High with a weighted mean of 3.97.

1.2 Cultural Values

The level of sociocultural factors in terms of Cultural Values is Very High with a weighted mean of 4.24.

1.3 Family Dynamics

The level of sociocultural factors in terms of Family Dynamics is Very High with a weighted mean of 4.35.

1.4 Peer Pressure

The level of sociocultural factors in terms of Peer Pressure is High with a weighted mean of 3.87.

2. What is the level of responsible young adulthood in terms of:

2.1 Sense of Responsibility

The level of responsible young adulthood in terms of a Sense of Responsibility is Very High with a weighted mean of 4.27.

2.2 Sense of Accountability

The level of responsible young adulthood in terms of a Sense of Accountability is Very High with a weighted mean of 4.37.

2.3 Ability to Respond to Commitments

The level of responsible young adulthood in terms of the Ability to Respond to Commitments is High with a weighted mean of 4.06.

2.4 Active Practice Ethics and Morals

The level of responsible young adulthood in terms of Active Practice Ethics and Morals is Very High with a weighted mean of 4.34.

Moreover, the researcher discusses the interpretation of the database on the results of the study given by the statistician. Lastly, the overall P-value level of

sociocultural factors and responsible young adulthood is 0.00001 which falls below the critical value of 0.05, therefore, the null hypothesis is rejected with the significant relationship level of strong positive correlation as this has the overall level of 0.701. It indicates a significant relationship between sociocultural factors and the development of responsibility in young adults. This outcome suggests that sociocultural factors such as social norms, cultural values, family dynamics, and peer pressure are not merely incidental but play a meaningful role in shaping responsible behaviors during this developmental stage.

Conclusions

This study examined the relationship between sociocultural factors and responsible young adulthood among the students. The researchers concluded that after

gathering samples and thoroughly investigating all of the aspects, they found out that sociocultural factors such as family dynamics, cultural values, and peer pressure significantly influence young adults' sense of responsibility, accountability, and ethical behavior. Family dynamics showed the strongest correlation with responsible young adulthood ($r = 0.550$, $p = 0.0001$), followed by cultural values ($r = 0.538$, $p = 0.0001$) and peer pressure ($r = 0.557$, $p = 0.0001$). The overall sociocultural factors collectively demonstrated the highest correlation ($r = 0.701$, $p = 0.0001$), underscoring their integral role in shaping responsible behaviors.

Based on the results, this study rejects the null hypothesis and concludes that there is a significant relationship between sociocultural factors and responsible young adulthood. Sociocultural factors play a vital role in shaping responsibility, accountability, and ethical behavior among young adults. A supportive cultural and social environment, fostered by families, educators, and communities, is essential for guiding young people toward responsible adulthood.

Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusions of this study, the following recommendations are given:

1. School Administrators

- ***Program Development:*** Develop programs that strengthen family dynamics and cultural values within the school environment, given their very high mean scores and levels. They should emphasize the integration of family and cultural activities to enhance students' sense of responsibility and accountability.
- ***Policy Implementation*****:** Implement policies that address peer pressure and social

norms, ensuring a supportive atmosphere that promotes ethical behavior and strong moral values among students.

- ***Engagement Activities:*** Participate in school activities that reinforce the importance of cultural values and family dynamics. This can help in developing a strong sense of responsibility and accountability.
- ***Peer Support Networks:*** Create and join peer support networks to help manage peer pressure and encourage each other to practice ethics and morals actively.

2. Teachers:

- ***Classroom Integration:*** Integrate lessons that emphasize the importance of cultural values and family dynamics in shaping responsible young adulthood. Use real-life examples to illustrate cause-and-effect relationships and the problem-solution approach in decision-making.
- ***Mentorship Programs:*** Develop mentorship programs that guide students in understanding and managing peer pressure, thereby fostering a high level of accountability and responsible behavior.

3. Parents:

- ***Family Involvement:*** Engage in family activities that emphasize cultural values and strong family dynamics. This involvement is crucial for nurturing a sense of responsibility and accountability in children.
- ***Communication:*** Maintain open lines of communication with children about the importance of ethics and morals, helping them navigate the complexities of peer pressure and social norms.

4. Future Researchers:

Further Studies and ***Longitudinal Research***. In-depth studies and tracking the impact of sociocultural factors on young adults will provide insights into how these factors can Be effectively utilized in fostering responsible young adult.